during the Delta wave, India did not ban travel from at-risk nations. We escalated our testing and tracking strategy keeping a sharp focus on those arriving from these nations. We understood that blanket bans cannot stop the variant from spreading in our people and neither can it really buy us any significant amount of time. We also were more confident in the protection that our high-coverage vaccination drive provided to citizens in addition to the high rates of immunity due to previous infections as evidenced by our updated sero-surveillance, i.e., hybrid immunity.[19] Yet, sections of the media and the Opposition demanded that India begin to boost its people. The Lancet published a study[20] which suggested that protection offered by the Oxford AstraZeneca vaccine Covishield declines after three months. This stirred panic. The media and the Opposition amplified their demand for a blanket booster dose. However, after cautious analysis of the study, experts felt that the methodology used in the study was odd: one they had never seen before. President of the Indian Medical Association Dr J.A. Jayala went on to say,

> Unfortunately, this study has a strange methodology, which none of us, including my peers, had ever seen before… So my point is, without discrediting the study authors, methodologies are very important when we come to understanding conclusions. So my message is that one should never blindly jump to conclusions. This study is based on the author's conclusions. Most of the scientific data that is available says that vaccines provide antibodies and T cell immunity as well. It is based on certain facts. Most of the scientific data available from studies which have been conducted across the country and abroad have proved that antibody is not just stopping but it is continuing. We are concerned about the T cell immunity or/and cellular immunity which is long lasting by all chances and once you are getting infected with the virus or when you are getting the passive immunity by the Covishield, definitely you will have the effect of that sustaining for a longer time. It will be preventing you and helping you to come out of the severe infection you are getting.[21]

Another expert, chief of the Kerala State Indian Medical Association noted, 'Even till today, no decline has been observed as far as the protection offered by both vaccines, Covishield and Covaxin is concerned. No signal